

PROXIMITY

Reels Brief

May 2026 batch / for Dmitri / May 9, 2026

Two reels in this batch. Hero (matchmaking explainer, 3 hook variants for A/B testing) plus Reel 2 (5 tabs into split-screen). Hooks and screen flow below. You have creative liberty on motion, typography pacing, micro-animations, music, and visual punch inside the brand specs.

Brand specs

Colors pulled from useproximity.org. Background direction is being A/B tested: Dmitri produces Variant A of the hero on BOTH a light background (matches website) AND a dark background (matches vyrstudio cinematic reference set). Both posted as trial reels first, winner becomes the standard the rest of the batch is built on.

	Brand red	#E23A2F	Logo, headlines, CTA, accents. Matches logo SVG.
	White	#FFFFFF	Default reel background.
	Soft off-white	#FAFAFA	Optional softer bg. Matches site hero.
	Red tint	#FBE6E4	Soft red wash, badges, accents.
	Text dark	#0A0A0A	Body type, headlines on light bg.
	Text gray	#555555	Secondary type.
	Black	#000000	Pain-card punctuation only. White type with red accent.

- **Font:** Inter (Black for headlines, Regular for body).
- **Logo:** top-left, persistent on every reel.
- **Badge:** 'FOR WASHU STUDENTS' top-right, type-only (no WashU trademark marks).
- **Closing tagline (every reel):** Find your place. Skip the chaos.
- **CTA:** useproximity.org/matchmaking
- **Avoid:** em dashes, corporate language, fake urgency, anti-WashU framing.

Reel 1 (Hero): Matchmaking Explainer

30 sec, 9:16 vertical. Three hook variants for A/B testing. Body and close identical across all three.

Variant A: Visible-Payoff (recommended baseline)

Hook (locked): Open on 2 matched apartments already on screen in a cool animation - maybe stacked on top of one another and they slide in from the outside of opposite sides- feel free to be creative (**first badged 'TOP PICK' in brand red, second unbadged**), **peer reviews visible**. Text drops in: "Meet your WashU housing agent." Hold ~1s. Form then rewinds to blank, body begins.

Screens after hook

- Blank /matchmaking form on a phone.
- Form fills in with jump cuts (NOT real-time typing): budget, move-in date, group size, pets, preferred commute mode (walk / shuttle / bike), priority chips (e.g., 'walk to campus,' 'in-unit laundry'). Each field snaps in with a soft tick. Total form fill: under 5 seconds.

The student profile to use

A WashU junior or senior, group of 3, looking for fall housing near campus. Realistic, common, easy for viewers to project onto.

Form values to show on screen as the form fills:

- Budget: \$750/person/month
- Move-in: August 15, 2026
- Group size: 3
- Pets: No
- Commute mode: Walk
- Priority chips: "walk to campus," "in-unit laundry"

These values realistically pull two specific real properties as the top matches.

The two matched properties

TOP PICK card: Kingsbury Ave (Manor Real Estate), 3-bed, ~\$2,200/mo (~\$733/person)

Real reviews on file from named students who aren't your friend group:

- Sophie K, ★5: "Apartment is nice and spacious. I like the in unit washer and dryer."
- Ariana K, ★4: "Great location. Kind of expensive but makes sense because its close to WashU."
- Anonymous, ★5: "10 minute walk to both WashU and the loop. The place itself is really nice. Kitchen and bathroom are brand new."

Pull-quote to use in the reel: **Sophie K's "Apartment is nice and spacious. I like the in unit washer and dryer."** (named, ★5, hits the in-unit laundry priority the form just selected)

ALTERNATE card: Rosebury Rentals (6219-6221 Rosebury Ave), 3-bed

Three ★5 reviews from named students:

- Amy A, ★5: "Other people in my apartment building are non-students which I actually like a lot."
- Yuangun F, ★5: "The environment is great it's peaceful."
- Steven C, ★5: "Great property. I like having in unit laundry machines."
- Submit button taps. Brief red wash. Soft 'agent thinking' beat: 1-second moment where the screen shows the agent reviewing options (subtle UI motion). Implies intelligence without making a verifiable claim.
- 2 match cards animate in. First card has a 'TOP PICK' badge in brand red on the corner; second card is unbadged. Each card: property photo, walk-time stamp, price, peer review pull-quote.

"Scan lease for hidden fees" button appears in somewhere natural for each listing (maybe when you click on it, or on the card)

- Walk-time stamps land at WashU-relevant locations (Brookings, MedCampus, Olin, the Loop) tied to the student's chosen commute mode from the form fill.
- Clicks on the top pick, has a Brief write up on why its a good fit based on their budget, and theres a chatbot they can talk to if they want to see something differently. It also has suggested tradeoffs (ex. Would you pay \$100/mo more for a gym and in unit laundry?)
- Closing card: 'Find your home. Skip the chaos.' Logo + URL.
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Variant B: Cinematic Typography Two-Beat (vyrstudio 'Cravings don't sleep' pattern)

Hook (locked): Open cold on a clean white or soft off white frame. First beat types in letter by letter or word by word: "Off-campus housing search shouldn't be this difficult." Hold ~0.5s. Second beat appears (typed in or fade-add) as a resolution: "So we fixed it." maybe in red if it looks good. Beat drop. Form fill begins (body).

Screens after the hook: same as Variant A from blank form onward.

Variant C: Typing Search Bar

Hook (locked): Open on a search bar. Someone types 'off-campus housing near washu.' Autocomplete drops in chaotic suggestions (zillow, apartments.com, sidechat, reddit, etc.). Hard cut to red wash. Text drops in: "There's a faster way." Beat drop. Form fill begins.

Variant D: Screenshot Pile-On (peer voice from real WashU platforms)

Hook (locked): Open on a clean frame. screenshots start piling on top of one another in rapid succession: a Reddit r/wustl comment about housing stress, a Facebook WashU class group post complaining about a landlord, a Sidechat-style anonymous message about Zillow being useless, an Instagram DM screenshot, etc. Each lands with a soft thud sound. By the end of 2 seconds the pile is dense and chaotic. Hard cut to a clean frame. Text drops in: "Avoid the chaos. Meet Proximity" or "introducing Proximity". Beat drop. Form fill begins

Reel 2: 5 Tabs into Split-Screen

25 sec, 9:16 vertical.

Hook: Eyebrow line in brand red lands: 'OFF-CAMPUS HOUSING NEAR WASHU.' Then massive headline: "5 TABS. ZERO ANSWERS." Tabs animate in: zillow.com, apartments.com, random landlords, Facebook groups, reddit.

Screens after hook

- **0-6s. Hook (unchanged).** Eyebrow "OFF-CAMPUS HOUSING NEAR WASHU" → "5 TABS. ZERO ANSWERS." → tabs animate in.
- **6-7s. Split-screen reveal frame.** Quick STATIC frame showing both labels: "GET MATCHED" left, "OR BROWSE YOURSELF" right. No animation yet, just the labels lit up. Hold 1 second. Establishes "two paths" in the viewer's head.
- **7-13s. Full-frame PATH 1: GET MATCHED.** Camera/cut zooms to full-frame. Compressed matchmaking flow: form fills in 3 seconds, 2 match cards animate in (first with TOP PICK badge, second unbadged). 6 seconds total.

- **13-19s. Full-frame PATH 2: OR BROWSE YOURSELF.** Hard cut to full-frame. Cursor clicks a listing card, listing detail expands, peer reviews fade in, walk-time stamps to WashU locations land. 6 seconds.
- **19-22s. Final split-screen moment.** Pulls back to reveal both halves now showing their results, STATIC (not animated). Subtitle drops in connecting both halves: "Pick your style." Hold 3 seconds. This is the only moment both halves are visible together, and they're frozen so the viewer's eyes can absorb both.
- **22-25s. Closing card.** "Find your place. Skip the chaos." (or "Find your home." per the tagline question still open).

Reel 3: "The Agent in Action" (possible)

Shows the agent doing more: scanning a lease, comparing 3 buildings on walk time, surfacing a review from a past tenant. Pure graphics. Deepens the agent narrative across the batch. Pairs naturally with the hero. I don't have a great vision for this one but if you do I would love to have this - we could get some animation with my obsidian bc it's already tied to all the diff landlords and properties. Would show it scanning the lease, looking at the reviews, weighing in preferences - would likely want to talk with Wyatt before knowing exactly what we would want to show.

Your creative call

You have full creative liberty on motion design, typography pacing, micro-animations, transitions, music, and visual punch inside the brand specs above. The hooks and screen flow are the structure. The look is yours.

Production order: build Variant A first in both background colors (light and dark) for the trial reel A/B test. Once we have an engagement winner, build Variants B and C plus Reel 2 on the winning background so the batch stays visually coherent.

Two revision rounds per reel included. Source files (HTML, CSS, scenes) handed off with finals so future variants don't require coming back through you for every micro-change.

Send back: which hook copy reads strongest to you, anything in the screen flow that doesn't fit your pipeline, and your turnaround estimate on the first Variant A draft.